

Expectations for MASc Students

1. Guiding Principle

As a MASc student in this lab, your objective extends beyond simply completing a research project—you are expected to **master the foundational concepts and methodologies** of your field and demonstrate **intellectual independence, technical depth, and academic excellence**.

While many of your undergraduate peers may have transitioned directly into the workforce, your choice to pursue graduate research reflects a commitment to deeper intellectual challenge and long-term growth. To make the most of it, you should surpass the performance and growth trajectory of your industry-bound peers. This requires **sustained effort, focused engagement, and a high level of self-discipline**. You should regard yourself as a **full-time researcher** and a **part-time student**.

2. Research Productivity and Output

Qualitative Goal

- Pursue **professional growth** and **strive for excellence** in all aspects of your academic journey, with the goal of **growing into a skilled, independent, and excellent researcher**.

Quantitative Goal

- Complete **at least one ready-to-submit journal article (SCI)** before graduation.

Thesis Development

- The journal article will be co-developed with the PI, who will provide mentorship, feedback, and critical revisions. However, **the thesis is your sole academic responsibility**.
- Once the paper is finalized, converting it into a thesis is typically straightforward and mainly involves expanding the literature review.

3. Timeline for Completion

To ensure timely graduation, plan your milestones by working backward from your desired defense date. For example, the timeline for an August defense is as follows:

<u>Milestone</u>	<u>Note</u>	<u>Deadline</u>
Defense	Availability of examiners	End of August
Thesis Submission	2 weeks before defense	Beginning of August
Journal Paper Finalized	2 weeks to write thesis	Mid-July
Research and Experiments Done	3 months* to write paper	Mid-April

*The time required to write a research paper varies by individual, but on average, the process takes about three months, typically one month to complete the first draft and an additional two months for iterative revisions and feedback.